



## STATUS REPORT

# Namibia: status report

Edition of 2026-08-18 · 113 systems and instruments tracked, 12 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-17 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/NAM/ledger.csv](#) (113 systems and instruments, 12 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

**Status values.** *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

## Summary of position

Namibia is issuing an electronic identity card in September 2026 into a country with no data protection statute. The card is chipped, carries biometric and biographical data and a digital identity component for remote authentication, and is free for first-time applicants, renewals and amendments ([ministry account](#)). The Data Protection Bill has been in drafting for about twelve years, was announced for tabling in September 2025, and had not been tabled at 6 August 2026 ([tabling announcement](#)).

The statutory basis for the card is the Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024 ([the Act](#)), which officials read as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent. Existing identity documents stay valid until withdrawn by a gazette notice that has not been issued. An Access to Information Act was gazetted on 28 December 2022 and has not been brought into force ([the Act](#)).

The regulator refused a satellite operator's licence twice inside the window, on ownership, national security and compliance grounds, and dismissed 624 reconsideration requests ([regulator account](#)). The regulator's published sector and market series stops at 2023 data, so every later connectivity figure in this report is the operator's, the ministry's or an international body's.

# Infrastructure

## Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <small>source</small>       | MILESTONE                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 51% Namibian ownership requirement                                  | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Applied to refuse a licence 2026-03-23, the refusal upheld 2026-06-22                                                                 |
| Commercial 5G network                                               | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Commercial launch at end-August 2025 in three centres                                                                                 |
| CRAN Integrated Annual Report                                       | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Integrated Annual Report 2025 approved by the Board 2025-08-07, covering the year to 31 March 2025                                    |
| Determination of dominant position in the telecommunications market | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | 2024 determination gazetted 2024-08-15 (Government Gazette 8416, General Notice 456); the four market definitions unchanged from 2016 |
| First privately owned mobile network                                | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Launched 2025-09-02                                                                                                                   |
| Ministry strategic plan 2025-2030 and national ICT policy           | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Launched at Opuwo 2026-01-29                                                                                                          |
| Regional subsea and satellite integration agreement                 | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                     | Master service agreement signed 2026-06-12                                                                                            |
| Regulator coverage and subscriber statistics                        | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Latest published series reports 2023 data                                                                                             |
| Starlink operating licence                                          | DISCONTINUED, APPLICATION DECLINED <a href="#">↗</a> | Reconsideration requests dismissed 2026-06-22                                                                                         |
| Tax relief on fourth-generation devices                             | PLANNED, PROPOSAL ONLY <a href="#">↗</a>             | Proposed by the regulator's chief executive at a tower launch in Kunene                                                               |
| Tower-siting engagement with traditional authorities                | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                     | A convening held in the week to 2026-07-30                                                                                            |
| Twenty-five-tower programme                                         | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                        | Twenty-five towers inaugurated across nine regions, August 2025                                                                       |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <small>source</small> | MILESTONE                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Commercial data centres in operation                                    | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                  | Named as established commercial facilities 2026-06-15                                      |
| National and public data centre                                         | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                      | Cabinet directed a concept note and project proposal, September 2025                       |
| National Digital Strategy                                               | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                  | Published August 2025                                                                      |
| Vendor-built national data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>               | The smart-city arrangement signed at the end of June 2026, funding acknowledged 2026-07-08 |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <small>source</small> | MILESTONE |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Power supply plan for the national data centre | NOT HELD                                       | —         |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT           | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <small>source</small> | MILESTONE                                   |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Fraud and cybersecurity summit | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                  | An inaugural summit convened, November 2025 |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                     | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government-sector incident response team and security operations centres | PLANNED ↗       | Cabinet approved establishment, November 2025                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| India cyber security memorandum                                          | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Signed at State House during a visit, July 2025                                                                                                                                                                                |
| NAM-CSIRT cybersecurity landscape report                                 | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Second annual edition published 2026-04-11, covering calendar 2025 attack and vulnerability data and FY2025/26 institutional progress                                                                                          |
| National computer security incident response team                        | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | The second-quarter 2026 newsletter published 2026-07-22; NAM-CSIRT states it completed Phase 3 of its three-year implementation plan in FY2025/26, marking full operationalisation, having been officially launched 2025-04-14 |
| National Cybersecurity Incident Management Guidelines 2026               | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Launched by the ICT ministry, April 2026                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Public-service cyber training partnership                                | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Memorandum signed 2026-06-04                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Regulator and chamber of commerce memorandum                             | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Signed in Windhoek 2026-07-30 for a three-year term                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Regulator as root certification authority                                | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | The role stated by the regulator 2026-07-29                                                                                                                                                                                    |

The [51% Namibian ownership requirement](#) is the operative instrument in this section. It was applied to refuse a satellite operator's combined service and spectrum licence on 23 March 2026, on three of six statutory criteria – ownership and control, national defence and public security, and compliance history – and the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight ([refusal account](#)). Of 624 reconsideration requests, 622 failed the legal threshold and two were refused on merits.

Networks were built by others. Commercial fifth-generation service launched at the end of August 2025 in Windhoek, Swakopmund and Walvis Bay ([cabinet account](#)); the country's first privately owned mobile network launched on 2 September 2025 with N\$600m invested in the preceding year ([launch account](#)); and 25 towers were inaugurated across nine regions at N\$40m in August 2025 ([tower account](#)). The regulator's own market series puts fourth-generation population coverage at 85% in 2022, with six of Namibia's 14 regions below 80% and Kunene lowest at 41% ([regulator series](#)); the 2023 edition puts coverage at 88.4% and Namibia's African 1GB-affordability ranking at 8th, up from 46th ([regulator summary](#)). CRAN's 2024 determination names Telecom Namibia dominant in all four defined markets, with NamPower in national data transmission and MTC in wireless end-user access ([determination](#)).

Cyber incidents are published quarterly. The response team recorded 513,921 vulnerabilities and 161,547 events in April to June 2026, up 39.8% and 56.7% on the prior quarter, a quarter after incident management guidelines were issued ([regulator account](#)). These are detections on the regulator's own sensors, not an incidence rate. NAM-CSIRT, launched 14 April 2025, states it completed Phase 3 of its implementation plan in 2025/26 and cannot fully execute its mandate for want of a cybersecurity law ([landscape report](#)).

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>  | MILESTONE                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Governmental interoperability solution | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | Delivered by an external academy with a technology partner; the project ran October 2014 to December 2016 |
| Inter-ministry data-exchange platform  | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Named by a development agency as being deployed for secure inter-ministry sharing                         |
| National data exchange service bus     | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | Reported linking electronic birth and death notification platforms to the population register             |
| Government interoperability framework  | NOT HELD                         | —                                                                                                         |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>  | MILESTONE                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Electronic identity fee schedule              | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | Duplicate fees stated 2026-08-01                                                     |
| Electronic identity public awareness campaign | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | The Omaheke leg ran 2026-07-27 to 2026-08-05 across all seven constituencies         |
| Identity card for refugees                    | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | Issuance began June 2024; 682 cards issued in 2025                                   |
| National electronic identity card             | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Ten-year card validity and PIN authentication set out 2026-08-01                     |
| Randomly generated identity number            | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Confirmed for first-time applicants from September 2026                              |
| School-based identity registration drive      | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | 24 of 55 target schools reached by 2026-07-23; the drive runs April to end-July 2026 |
| Youth e-ID Ambassadors Programme              | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | Reported running 2026-08-13                                                          |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>                           | MILESTONE                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cash assistance to refugees through mobile money               | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                             | Launched February 2025 for about 6,000 individuals in over 1,000 households                |
| Declaration of intent on instant payments integration          | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                             | Signed by the central bank, the instant payments company and the clearing house            |
| Instant Payment Solution                                       | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                             | Live from June 2026 with three participating institutions                                  |
| Interbank settlement system                                    | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                             | Migration to the international messaging standard confirmed                                |
| National Payment System Strategy 2021-2025                     | DISCONTINUED <a href="#">↗</a>                            | Closed at an 87% average implementation rate over five years                               |
| National Payment System Vision 2030                            | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                          | The next phase in drafting                                                                 |
| National quick-response payment standard                       | IN DEVELOPMENT, STANDARD FINALISED <a href="#">↗</a>      | Finalisation reported in the payments association's 2025 annual report                     |
| Open banking specifications                                    | IN DEVELOPMENT, SPECIFICATIONS COMPLETE <a href="#">↗</a> | Specifications completed, reported 2026-07-28                                              |
| Participation in the pan-African payment and settlement system | PLANNED, NOT CONFIRMED <a href="#">↗</a>                  | A regional bank targeted central bank sign-up by its Windhoek seminar of 5-8 November 2024 |
| Payment System Management Act 14 of 2023                       | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                             | In force 2023-08-08                                                                        |
| Transfer of payment-provider licensing to the central bank     | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                          | Announced under a new framework at the payments association's annual general meeting       |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------|
| Payments association 2025 annual report | NOT HELD        | —         |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Business and intellectual property online registration | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Online name search, name reservation and application-status verification offered |
| Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024   | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Assented 2024-12-30                                                              |
| National population registration system                | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Operating since at least 2020; the register the September 2026 card is built on  |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Community System for community health workers | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | National training held at Swakopmund in the week to 2026-07-29; no rollout date announced |
| National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036              | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Launched 2026-02-06                                                                       |
| National eHealth Strategy 2021-2025                   | DISCONTINUED ↗   | Superseded by the National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036, launched 2026-02-06           |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Government Strategic Roadmap 2024-2026                | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Sets a target of digital identities for at least 25% of the population by 2026             |
| Legally recognised electronic signatures                      | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Nationwide deployment targeted February 2026; accreditation of service providers under way |
| Target of full digitisation of government services by 2029/30 | PLANNED ↗        | Target stated by the ICT minister at a tower inauguration                                  |

## Rural digital data capture

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Satellite connectivity partnership with Angola | PILOTING ↗      | A pilot commercial agreement signed at a forum in Luanda |

## Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | STATUS ↗ source                                    | MILESTONE                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Windhoek People-Centred Smart City Strategy 2026-2036 | IMPLEMENTED, NO FINANCING OR TIMETABLE PUBLISHED ↗ | Adopted by the City of Windhoek council 2026-06-15 |

## National statistics

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                  |
|------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 population and housing census | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Namibia's first fully digital census; population 3,022,401 |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Namibia Statistics Agency Strategic Plan 2022/23-2026/27 | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Institutional plan covering the agency's 2022/23-2026/27 period; the plan carries no publication date and is dated to the start of its own period |
| National strategy for the development of statistics      | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Published February 2023, covering the strategy period 2023/24-2026/27                                                                             |
| Special data dissemination standard subscription         | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Subscribed December 2022, one of about seven African countries                                                                                    |
| Statistics agency microdata catalogue and data portals   | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Data portals and NADA microdata catalogue captured 2026-08-09; neither page carries its own publication date                                      |
| Statistics Awareness Day                                 | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | An inaugural event held at Gobabis, convened by the central bank and the statistics agency                                                        |

## Use of satellite data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Satellite data-receiving ground station | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Handed over by China at the earth station outside Windhoek |
| Space Science and Technology Bill       | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Cabinet approved drafting during 2025                      |

The identity card is the country's largest live programme and it has not issued a card yet. Rollout is set for September 2026, first-time applicants receive a randomly generated number with the legacy number retained on the reverse ([ministry account](#)), and the card is valid for 10 years against the indefinite lifespan of the document it replaces, with a first duplicate at N\$150 and a second at N\$300 ([ministry account](#)). Regional outreach ran through Omaheke from 27 July to 5 August with a development agency and the regulator ([outreach account](#)).

The document backlog beneath it is measured. Between 1 April 2025 and 30 June 2026 the ministry printed 166,237 identity documents and 125,999 were collected, leaving 40,238 uncollected ([ministry figures](#)) — about a quarter of the print run. A school-based registration drive had reached 24 of 55 target schools by 23 July 2026.

Payments moved from build to live. The instant payment solution became operational in June 2026 with three participating institutions, on a phased national rollout with government-to-person social grants the first use case ([central bank account](#)). The quick-response standard is finalised and the open banking specifications complete, both known only through press reporting of an annual report the wiki does not hold ([report account](#)).

Windhoek's council adopted a People-Centred Smart City Strategy 2026-2036 on 15 June 2026, naming commercialisation of the city's own fibre-optic network as the digital backbone; no funding requirement, implementation timetable or institutional owner is published ([council account](#)). A National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036 was launched on 6 February 2026, succeeding the electronic health strategy whose period expired at the end of 2025 ([regional office account](#)).

Namibia's statistics system rests on parallel plans. The National Strategy for the Development of Statistics 2023/24-2026/27 costs ten sector plans at N\$58,995,000 over four years, drafted with African Development Bank, Paris21, UNDP and UNFPA support ([the strategy](#)); the agency's own, separate Strategic Plan 2022/23-2026/27 records that funding was adequate only until about 2016 and that the census could not proceed in August 2021 or 2022 for want of funds ([the plan](#)). The agency also runs a NADA microdata catalogue of 16 studies dated 1992-2023, agency-run data dissemination rather than a government-wide open data policy ([data portals](#)).

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>  | MILESTONE                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Corporate Laws Bill 2025                     | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Draft 3 out for comment by stakeholders and the general public |
| Cybercrime Bill                              | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Named by the ICT minister as being finalised, 2026-07-14       |
| Data Protection Bill                         | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Still in finalisation; not tabled                              |
| Data Protection Bill, latest published draft | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Published for comment by the ministry, March 2022              |
| Electronic Transactions Act 2019             | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>    | In force from March 2021                                       |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>  | MILESTONE                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Artificial-intelligence legislation       | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>        | Sequenced behind the strategy, per the ICT minister                |
| National artificial-intelligence strategy | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a> | Consultations reported begun under the research council 2026-08-05 |

### Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                      | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>                | MILESTONE                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Namibia's seat on an international artificial-intelligence commission                     | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                  | The ICT minister named among the commission's members                                               |
| Namibia-Angola information technology and media memorandum                                | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                  | Signed at the opening of a technology forum in Luanda                                               |
| Namibia-Botswana information and communications technology memorandum                     | PLANNED, SIGNATURE ANNOUNCED <a href="#">↗</a> | Signature announced for 2026-08-06 at Kasane                                                        |
| Namibia-Republic of Congo information technology memorandum                               | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                      | Cabinet approved and authorised signature, announced 2026-07-23                                     |
| Pan-African language artificial-intelligence initiative                                   | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>               | Launched at a continental telecommunications conference with Namibia's ICT ministry a named partner |
| Ratification of the continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection | NOT HELD                                       | —                                                                                                   |

### Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                       | STATUS <a href="#">↗ source</a>                             | MILESTONE                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Data-subject rights provisions of the Data Protection Bill | DISCONTINUED, REMOVED IN THE 2022 REDRAFT <a href="#">↗</a> | Part III, sections 8 to 14, present in the 2020 draft and absent from the March 2022 revised draft |
| Gazette notice withdrawing existing identity documents     | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                                   | Provided for; not issued at 2026-08-06                                                             |
| Smart-city grant agreement and annexures                   | NOT HELD                                                    | —                                                                                                  |

## Public debate and participation in policymaking

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill | DISCONTINUED ↗  | Consultation closed 2022-11-30; a coalition submission and an independent critique published |

## EU activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                       | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| European Union Multi-Annual Indicative Programme 2021-2027 | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Amended by Commission Implementing Decision C(2024)7502 at the mid-term review |

## Open data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                 | STATUS ↗ source          | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 and the Information Commissioner | ENACTED, NOT COMMENCED ↗ | Information Commissioner and Deputy Information Commissioner appointment regulations gazetted 2024-12-09 (signed 2024-11-15); the Act itself remains not commenced |
| National open data policy or government portal                       | NOT HELD                 | —                                                                                                                                                                  |

Two bills carry the section and neither has been tabled. The Data Protection Bill was announced for tabling in September 2025, about twelve years after drafting began ([tabling announcement](#)), and was still described as being finalised on 14 July 2026 ([ministerial account](#)). The Cybercrime Bill is named as being finalised alongside it, with no draft published and no tabling date. In the interim, law enforcement relies on the Electronic Transactions Act 2019, the Communications Act and the penal code.

The 2020 draft carries a Part on the rights of the data subject at sections 8 to 14; the version the ministry published for comment in March 2022 does not, and access and correction survive only as controller obligations ([the 2020 draft](#)).

The March 2022 draft was published for a five-week public consultation closing 30 November 2022 ([consultation notice](#)). The ACTION Namibia Coalition submitted on the closing date ([submission](#)), and the Institute for Public Policy Research published the same argument on 14 December 2022, calling the Bill "not fit for purpose" and its Supervisory Authority's independence provisions in need of substantial redrafting ([IPPR paper](#)). No ministry-published respondent list is held.

A Corporate Laws Bill was at Draft 3 and out for public comment in October 2025; its clause 114 would require every company to keep a register of beneficial owners in Namibia recording each owner's date of birth and identity-document number ([the draft](#)). The European Union's country programme for 2021-2027 sets no digital priority area: digitalisation is a cross-cutting priority, and the 2025-2027 allocation fixed at the mid-term review is EUR 26,000,000, with nil for foundational skills education ([the programme](#)).

Regulations for appointing an Information Commissioner and Deputy were gazetted 9 December 2024, signed 15 November 2024, setting five-year Selection Committee terms and a five-member quorum — machinery made under the Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 before that Act itself is in force ([the regulations](#)).



## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Artificial-intelligence readiness assessment                    | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Completed by the research council with the education ministry and an international body                  |
| Artificial-intelligence working group of the research council   | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | A multi-stakeholder platform with science, data and skills technical advisory committees                 |
| Indigenous-language voice-data repository                       | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Reported under construction 2026-08-13                                                                   |
| National artificial-intelligence institute                      | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                       | Recommended by a 2022 task force report; the sixth national development plan calls for a research centre |
| Consultancy engagement on the artificial-intelligence framework | NOT HELD                                        | —                                                                                                        |
| National high-performance computing facility                    | NOT HELD                                        | —                                                                                                        |

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Space Science and Technology Bill drafting approval | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Cabinet approved drafting, 2025 |

### Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Information technology venture capital fund                 | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                       | Cabinet authorised the ministry to engage female founders as potential beneficiaries         |
| University artificial-intelligence and robotics accelerator | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Launched with central bank funding; underpins Namibia's first artificial-intelligence degree |
| Start-up act                                                | NOT HELD                                        | —                                                                                            |

### US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                    |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Subsea cable landing at Swakopmund | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Landed at Swakopmund in 2022 |

### China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chinese contribution to the Windhoek smart city pilot | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | An arrangement signed at the end of June 2026; CNY 98,000,000 committed |

### India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PARAM HPC cluster at NUST | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Specification published on an undated page, captured 2026-08-09; described as a 5-node PARAM cluster to be deployed at NUST |

## Gulf/UAE activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | STATUS ↗ source          | MILESTONE                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gulf-state digital or artificial-intelligence cooperation agreement | PLANNED, PROPOSAL ONLY ↗ | Bilateral Economic Commission proposed at the Namibia-UAE Business Forum, 2026-02-18; no agreement signed |

The national artificial-intelligence strategy is in consultation and the legislation is sequenced behind it. The ministry stated on 3 August 2026 that consultations had begun under the research council and that government has prioritised a strategy before introducing legislation ([ministerial account](#)). The council's own chief executive and colleagues wrote in February 2026 that Namibia lacks a national strategy and lacks comprehensive legislation for data protection and cybersecurity ([council paper](#)).

The readiness work is done and the compute is not. A readiness assessment was completed in 2025 with an international body, and the council's working group runs the strategy process; a national institute recommended by a 2022 task force is proposed and not established, and no national high-performance computing facility exists in the base. A smaller, separate object does: a five-node PARAM cluster specified for NUST under the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology, with no operator, cost or opening date published, and a university research cluster rather than a national facility ([specification](#)).

The technology sector's one first-of-its-kind object is the satellite data-receiving ground station handed over by China on 12 February 2026, stated to be wholly Namibia-run by fourteen trained technicians ([handover account](#)). Cabinet approved drafting a space bill in 2025 and no text has been published.

Namibia's opening move with the Gulf is a proposal, not an instrument: at a Namibia-UAE Business Forum on 18 February 2026, the foreign minister proposed a Bilateral Economic Commission with technology transfer in its remit, the UAE side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements, and no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published ([forum account](#)).

## Inclusion and capacity

### Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                             |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulator sector and market report series | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | ICT Sector Market Report 2023 published November 2024 |

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 100% telecommunications coverage by 2030               | PLANNED ↗       | Target set 2025-06-03 for 2030                                    |
| Free internet for schools and clinics under new towers | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Seven years' free access confirmed at a ministerial staff meeting |

Literacy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Information and Communication school syllabus | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Grade 8 & 9 syllabus published December 2024 for implementation in Grade 8 (2025) and Grade 9 (2026); the subject is a compulsory, non-promotional but assessable subject for Grade 4-12 |
| National digital literacy programme           | NOT HELD        | —                                                                                                                                                                                        |

Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government technology staff cyber-skills programme | PLANNED ↗       | Cabinet approved; the Office of the Prime Minister directed to coordinate phased implementation |

Financial inclusion rose from 78% in 2017 to 86% in 2025 on the central bank's own account, which also named continued cash reliance, limited rural access, informal-sector barriers and the digital divide as persistent constraints ([central bank account](#)). A second held source [describes the same 78% as current in July 2025](#), and the two accounts date it eight years apart.

Connectivity commitments are stated as targets rather than delivery. The ministry set 100% telecommunications coverage by 2030 in June 2025, against about 360,000 people outside fourth-generation coverage at February 2024, and reported 339 schools and 50 health centres without adequate connectivity ([ministry account](#)). Schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years receive free internet for seven years, with no list or count of covered sites published ([ministerial statement](#)).

The universal service fund launched on 19 March 2025 with N\$145,000,000 of government seed funding over three years, and priority goes to the five regions where fourth-generation coverage is below 80% — Kavango West, Kavango East, Kunene, Ohangwena and Oshikoto — with 16 schools and four clinics selected for uncapped Wi-Fi ([launch account](#)). No disbursement or balance figure has been published since; the recorded output is 100 handsets distributed to learners in Kunene in February 2026 ([fund account](#)).

Information and Communication is a compulsory, non-promotional but assessable subject for Grade 4 to 12: the Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 for 2021 implementation, and the Grade 8 and 9 syllabus followed in December 2024 for phased implementation in 2025 and 2026 ([grade 8 & 9 syllabus](#)). No standalone national digital-literacy strategy or programme exists outside this school curriculum.

Finance

New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT              | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Private mobile network investment | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | The network launched 2025-09-04                                                     |
| Universal Service Fund            | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Launched 2025-03-19 with N\$145,000,000 of government seed funding over three years |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Universal service levy                 | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Regulations Prescribing Universal Service Levy made 2024-09-27 (Government Gazette 8455, General Notice 559), effective on publication |
| Universal Service Fund annual accounts | NOT HELD        | —                                                                                                                                      |

## Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------|
| Information and communications technology ministry budget vote | NOT HELD        | —         |

Paratus invested N\$600,000,000 in its private mobile network in the year to its September 2025 launch ([launch account](#)). The Universal Service Fund launched 19 March 2025 with N\$145,000,000 of government seed funding over three years — CRAN's own Integrated Annual Report 2025 gives N\$115,000,000 for the same launch, unreconciled ([fund launch account](#); [CRAN account](#)). The levy feeding the Fund was made 27 September 2024 at not exceeding 0.5% of annual turnover, after a 2022 notice of intention was withdrawn in June 2024 for a revised evidence base ([the levy](#)). No technology ministry budget vote and no Fund annual accounts are held for any year.

## Gaps to fill

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | LAST PROBED |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Consultancy engagement on the artificial-intelligence framework     | A procurement award notice, terms of reference or signed advisory agreement; the base carries two accounts of a 2026-08-03 meeting and the minister's statement that the research council leads, and no contract, scope of work, procurement route or value, with none listed on the central procurement board                                                                                                                    | 2026-08-06  |
| National high-performance computing facility                        | A research council or ministry announcement, procurement notice or budget line for a national compute facility; the base carries the council's own statement that its data committee is to provide such centres and that securing computing infrastructure is a next step, and separately that a vendor is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads, with no named facility, site, capacity, cost or operator | 2026-08-06  |
| Start-up act                                                        | A gazetted act or a published bill; a held source records that at 2026-08-09 no gazetted or tabled start-up legislation could be located and that the nearest policy instrument, the National Informal Economy, Start-ups and Entrepreneurship Development Policy, is not published at any URL, so what is outstanding is confirmation that none exists rather than a document                                                    | 2026-08-06  |
| Government interoperability framework                               | A published interoperability framework, standard or governing instrument; the base names three data-exchange objects across ten years and establishes no relationship between them, no operating body and no governance rules                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2026-08-06  |
| Payments association 2025 annual report                             | The report itself; the base holds two press accounts of its 2026-07-28 release and no primary, and the association's own site publishes only a memorandum and a board release, so four payment rows stand on press reporting of one unheld document                                                                                                                                                                               | 2026-08-06  |
| National open data policy or government portal                      | A portal address, a dataset catalogue or a policy document; the subject holds nothing for Namibia, and the nearest held material is central bank and statistics agency statements on administrative data, which concern data quality rather than publication                                                                                                                                                                      | 2026-08-06  |
| Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill | A ministry consultation notice, submissions register or committee record; the base carries only two sources on this subject and a researcher's statement that the public had not seen the latest draft at 2025-08-17                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2026-08-06  |
| Smart-city grant agreement and annexures                            | The signed grant agreement, its annexures, the contractor list and the data architecture; the base carries an opposition member's characterisation and a presidential acknowledgement of the amount, with no instrument text, and does not establish the Chinese disbursing agency                                                                                                                                                | 2026-08-06  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                             | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | LAST PROBED |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Ratification of the continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection</b> | The continental depositary list entry or a Namibian instrument of ratification or accession; the base carries 20 sources on this subject, all bilateral or convened by an industry body, and none names a continental or regional data-governance instrument Namibia has acceded to                                                      | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>National digital literacy programme</b>                                                       | A named ministry or regulator digital-literacy strategy, curriculum or programme document; the subject carries exactly one Namibian source, the regulator and chamber memorandum of 2026-07-30, which names digital literacy as a workstream with no funding, deliverable or target                                                      | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Information and communications technology ministry budget vote</b>                            | The ministry's vote in the appropriation bill or its budget-vote motivation speech; the base holds no Namibian technology appropriation of any year, and the one appropriation figure held anywhere in the base is the civil registration department's, on a source tagged to other subjects                                             | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Universal Service Fund annual accounts</b>                                                    | The fund's annual report, or the regulator's disclosure of levy receipts and project disbursements; the base establishes the fund exists, its launch month, its initial endowment and two in-kind outputs, all from secondary reporting of ministerial statements, and carries no levy rate, contribution base, receipts or project list | 2026-08-06  |
| <b>Power supply plan for the national data centre</b>                                            | A power purchase agreement, grid-connection study or energy annex to the data-centre project proposal; the subject carries one Namibian source, a signed opinion piece arguing the case for hosting compute locally, so there is no held statement of how any planned facility would be powered, at what cost, or by whom                | 2026-08-06  |

Namibia's absences are specific things the state does not publish.

The regulator's published sector and market series stops at 2023 data, so no Namibian connectivity measure later than that can be stated on the wiki's own authority. The technology ministry's budget vote is not held for any year, and the single appropriation figure anywhere in the base is the civil registration department's.

Four payment positions — the quick-response standard, the open banking specifications, the settlement system migration and the closing implementation rate of the 2021-2025 payments strategy — all rest on press reporting of one annual report the wiki does not hold, and the association's own site does not publish it.

No national open data policy or government portal is held for Namibia; the nearest held material is central bank and statistics agency statements on administrative data, which concern data quality rather than publication.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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| LICENCE         | <a href="#">CC BY 4.0</a>                                                                                                                                       |

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.